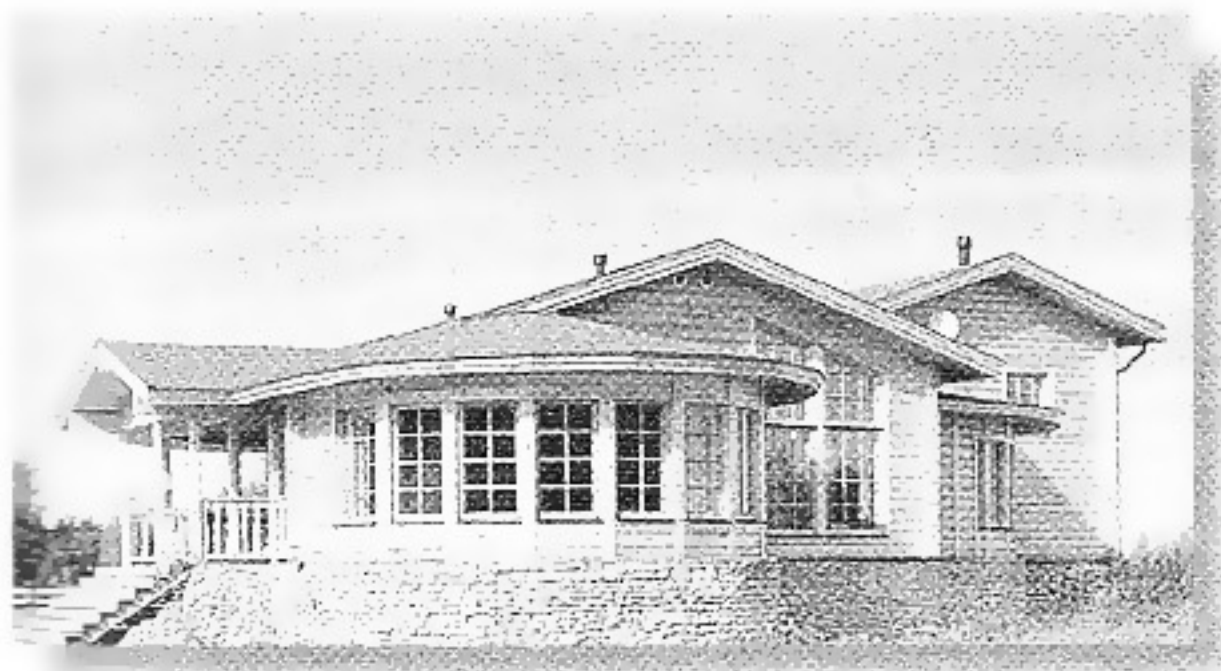


4 HOUSING



A good home must be made, not bought.

Joyce Maynard

It matters less to a person where they are born than where they can live.

Turkish Proverb

□ VOCABULARY INPUT

Dealing with this topic you will come across the following vocabulary. Read it and look up the unknown words in your dictionary.

- **living in a city/town: (urban area)**

advantages: job opportunities, sports facilities, cultural events, schooling possibilities, health establishments, nightlife, shopping centres, public transport, cosmopolitan

disadvantages: crowded, polluted, noisy, hectic, dangerous, high rate of crime, cost of living, traffic jams, problems with parking

- **living in the country: (rural area)**

advantages: peaceful, quiet, calm, nature, growing plants/flowers/crops, keeping animals, gardens, farms

disadvantages: no privacy, lack of cultural events, poor public transport connections

- **location:** situated in a residential area, in the city, right in the centre, on the outskirts of town, in the suburbs, in the countryside, in the village, in a block of flats, in a housing estate, in walking distance from..., nearby sports facilities

- **types of dwelling/shelter:** block of flats, house, caravan, houseboat, lighthouse, hut, chalet, cottage, tent, castle, palace
in Britain: flats (penthouse apartment, suite, bedsit), houses (detached, semi-detached, terraced, back-to-back, bungalow, mansion, country house)

in America: apartment/condominium (condo), row house, duplex

- **exterior:** garden (backyard, front yard), patio, swimming pool, greenhouse, fence, hedge, garage, gate, path, driveway

- **interior:** ground floor, first floor, stairs, central heating/floor heating, sauna, Jacuzzi, double glazed windows, French windows, skylight, safety entrance door

- **types of rooms:** entrance, back room, front room, dining room, living room/sitting room, bedroom, study, hall, kitchen, playroom, bathroom, laundry room, storage, cellar, loft, attic, basement

- **furniture:** settee/sofa/couch, armchairs, wall unit, hi-fi system, TV set, DVD player, bookcase, coffee table, fireplace, cupboards, sink, table with chairs/stools, single bed, double bed, bunk beds, built-in wardrobes, dressing table, mirror on the wall, toilet (lavatory), bidet, shower, bath, washbasin, shelves, chest of drawers, bedside tables, lamp, chandelier

on the floor: carpet, tiles, rug, wooden floor, *on the windows:* blinds, curtains, *on the walls:* concrete, painted walls, wallpaper

- **household appliances:** cooker, grill, oven, microwave oven, fridge with ice-crusher, freezer, toaster, food processor, dishwasher, washing machine, dryer, vacuum cleaner, air-conditioner, kettle, coffee machine, (ceiling) fan, humidifier, heater

- **activities around the house:** mowing the lawn, sowing seeds, weeding the flowerbeds, planting flowers, watering, building a greenhouse, trimming the hedge, cutting tree branches, fixing leaking pipes and roofs, decorating, sweeping the patio

- **describing the place where you live:** small (tiny)/large (huge, enormous, spacious), light/dark, draughty, noisy/quiet, decorated, modern, old-fashioned, warm and cosy

- **problems connected with living:** sharing with e.g. parents/roommates, renting (tenant), taking a mortgage, intolerant/noisy/nosy neighbours, homelessness

1. What options do people have when they want to create their own homes?
2. Talk about the advantages and disadvantages of living in towns and cities following the ideas in the text above.

TYPES OF HOUSING IN BRITAIN, THE USA AND SLOVAKIA

British people prefer to live in houses rather than flats. There are several types of houses in Britain: **terraced houses**, **back-to-back houses**, **semi-detached houses**, **detached houses** and **bungalows**. Terraced houses are built in a **row**, back-to-back houses share a back wall, semi-detached houses are **joined** together by one **common** wall. A detached house stands alone and a bungalow is built on one level. **Cottages**, small traditional country houses, are quite popular in our country. Some families have cottages near **woods** or lakes and like to spend their weekends there. British people also like country houses. Some British families have them in France. A typical British house **is set** in a small garden and has two **storeys**. It is usually **designed** for a family of four or five people. There is a hall, a front room, a back room, a kitchen and a **storage space** downstairs. A garage is normally **attached to** the house. Upstairs, there is one big bedroom and two smaller ones, a bathroom and a **lavatory**. In Britain, the size of **property** is **determined by** the number of bedrooms.

In the centre of big American cities, many people live in **apartments** (flats) situated in large apartment buildings whose **owners** live there too. They are called **condominiums (condos)**. Many Americans live in detached houses with a front yard and a back yard (a garden).

Many Slovaks live in flats. A flat is situated in the same building as other flats, often forming part of a **block of flats**. These days, a lot of housing estates are being reconstructed and new ones are being built. Slovak houses are usually quite big and the older ones are sometimes shared by two families – grandparents, their children and grandchildren. Living in **rented** flats and houses is becoming quite normal especially for younger families.

3. What are common types of houses/dwellings in Britain, the USA and Slovakia?
4. What does a typical British house look like?

INTERIOR – ROOMS, FURNITURE AND HOUSEHOLD APPLIANCES

The furniture in British and Slovak rooms is not very different nowadays. The sitting room has a **settee** and armchairs, a **wall unit** with a hi-fi system, a TV set and a DVD player, a **bookcase** and a coffee table. Most British houses have a **fireplace due to** the cold weather. Kitchen furniture includes kitchen **cupboards**, a **sink**, a **cooker** and a **fridge-freezer**. They are usually all **built-in**. There is also a table with chairs or **stools**. The floor in the kitchen is often **tiled**. The bedroom has a double bed, built-in **wardrobes**, a dressing table with a mirror on the wall and a stool in front of the table. American houses are well-furnished and **equipped with** modern **household appliances**, such as a cooker, a grill, an **oven**, a mic-

rowave oven, a **kettle**, a fridge with an **ice-crusher**, a freezer, a toaster, a **food processor**, a dishwasher, a washing machine, a **dryer**, a vacuum cleaner and an air-conditioner, amongst others. Each child in the family has his/her own room. Like British people, Americans do not usually stay in the same house their whole lives. Some families like to move to other parts of the country and change houses more than once in a **decade**. They usually **hire a removal company** to move their furniture, appliances and other necessary **equipment**.

5. How do Slovak and British houses differ according to the text above?
6. Compare the household appliances that an average American and Slovak family have.

EXTERIOR

Both Slovaks and British people love decorating their houses and gardening. Slovaks **tend to** have bigger gardens behind their houses and they spend quite a lot of time **growing** vegetables and fruit. British gardens are rather small and are more often used for relaxation than for growing vegetables. There is a lot of work around the house **throughout the whole year**. Slovaks are said to be very **skilful** and do a lot of work themselves. **Mowing the lawn, sowing seeds, weeding the flowerbeds**, planting flowers, watering them, building a **greenhouse**, **trimming the hedge**, cutting tree **branches**, **fixing** roofs, painting rooms, putting in the flooring and other jobs in the home are **manageable** without taking any special DIY (Do-It-Yourself) course or needing to study any manuals.

7. What do Slovaks and British use gardens for?
8. Why is it said that Slovaks are very skilful?

BUYING A HOUSE/FLAT

Both in Slovakia and Great Britain, it is not easy to buy one's own flat or a house. In both countries, the prices of property are extremely high. It is impossible for a young family to buy a flat without their parents' help or a **mortgage**. They have to **pay it off** in regular monthly **instalments**. **In order to** buy a house, a family does not need to have all the money anymore – there are many banks from which it is possible to **borrow** up to 90 per cent of the **value** of the house as a mortgage. Almost half of all British families own the houses in which they live. A lot of them pay off their mortgages for many years after moving into a house. In our country, more and more people **take advantage of** mortgages too. Some **take out a loan** for the reconstruction of their flats or houses. However, after the **credit crunch**, it has become more difficult in both countries to borrow money from a bank.

9. What are the advantages and disadvantages of taking out a mortgage?
10. What is meant by the term "credit crunch" mentioned in the text above?

□ VOCABULARY LIST

advantage – výhoda	inhabitant – obyvateľ
apartment (AmE) – byt	instalments – mesačné splátky
attached to – pripojený k	in order to – aby, za účelom
back-to back house – dom spojený s druhým domom zadnou stenou	joined – spojený
block of flats – panelák	kettle – varná kanvica
bookcase – knižnica (police)	lavatory – toaleta
to borrow – požičať si	manageable – zvládnuteľný
branch – konár	marked (by) – poznačený
built-in – vstavaný	mess – neporiadok
bungalow – bungalov (prízemný dom)	mortgage [mɔːɡɪdʒ] – hypotéka
burglar [bɜːɡlə] – vlamač, zlodej	murderer [mɜːdəra] – vrah
common – spoločný	noisy – hlučný
compromise [kəmpraɪz] – kompromis	noticeable – značný, očividný
condominium (condo) – kondomínium, vlastný byt v spoločnej bytovej zástavbe v meste	option [ɒpʃən] – voľba
cooker – sporák	on (the) one hand – na jednej strane
cottage – chalupa	on the other hand – na druhej strane
credit crunch [krɪtʃ] – úverová kríza	oven [ʌvən] – rúra
crowded – preplnený	owner – majiteľ
cupboard – kuchynská linka	to pay off – splácať
decade [dekeɪd, also dɪkeɪd] – dekáda	pickpocket – vreckový zlodej
to design – navrhnuť	polluted [pəˈluːtɪd] – znečistený
desire [dɪzaɪə] – túžba	property – majetok
detached house [dɪtætʃt] – samostatný dom	to provide [prəˈvaɪd] – poskytnúť
determined (by) – určený	to raise – vychovať
disadvantage – nevýhoda	rented – prenajatý
dryer – sušička	roof [ruːf] – strecha
due to [djuː tə] – kvôli	row – rad
equipment – vybavenie, zariadenie	semi-detached house – dvojdom
equipped (with) – zariadený, vybavený	set (in) – umiestnený, vsadený (do)
facility [fəˈsɪlɪti] – vybavenie; možnosť	settee [setiː] – gauč
factory chimney [tʃɪmni] – komín továrne	to settle down – usadiť sa
fireplace – kozub	shoplifter – zlodej v obchode
to fix – opraviť	shopping mall – nákupné centrum
food processor – kuchynský robot	sink – kuchynský drez
fridge-freezer – chladnička s mrazničkou	skilful (AmE: skillful) – zručný, obratný
fume [fjuːm] – dym	stool [stuːl] – stolička bez operadla
goods – tovar	storage space [stɔːrɪdʒ speɪs] – skladovací priestor
greenhouse – skleník	storey – poschodie
to grow – pestovať	suburb – predmestie
to hold – konať sa, usporiadať	to tend (to) – smerovať, inklinovať k
household appliance [haʊshəʊld əˈplaɪəns] – domáci spotrebič	terraced house – dom v radovej zástavbe
housing estate – sídlisko	tiled [taɪld] – vydláždený
ice-crusher – drvič ľadu	value – hodnota
to influence – ovplyvniť	wall unit – zostava nábytku do obývačky
	wardrobe – šatník
	wood – les

to hire a removal company – prenajať si
sťahovaciu službu
to mow the lawn – kosiť trávnik
to sow seeds – sadiť semená
to take advantage of – využiť
to take out a loan – vziať si úver

throughout the whole year [θru:ˈaʊt] –
počas celého roka
to trim the hedge – strihať živý plot
to weed the flowerbeds [wi:d] – plieť kveti-
nové záhony

□ VOCABULARY PRACTICE

Task 1 Match the types of housing below to their descriptions.

See the pictures of different types of houses on the DVD (Presentations): Unit 4.



DWELLINGS

e.g. semi-detached c

1. detached _____
2. block of flats _____
3. cottage _____
4. chalet _____
5. tent _____
6. mansion _____
7. caravan _____
8. terraced houses _____
9. condominium _____
10. duplex _____
11. bungalow _____
12. houseboat _____

DESCRIPTIONS

- a) a building containing a number of apartments
- b) a small country house
- c) a house attached to another house
- d) a house which is not connected to other houses
- e) a large country house
- f) a portable place to live made of canvas or other fabric
- g) an apartment situated in a large building which is owned by the people who live there (the USA)
- h) a mobile place to live on wheels
- i) a row of houses joined together
- j) a large house, typical for the USA, divided into two separate homes
- k) a holiday home, normally found in the mountains
- l) the river boat where you can live
- m) a small one-storey house

Task 2 Read the following descriptions. Which room/place is described?
What else do people use these rooms/places for?



Example: A place at home where you can work. STUDY

1. The place where you sleep. _____
2. This place is below ground level. _____
3. This place connects the other rooms together. _____
4. All the cooking happens in this room. _____
5. This is at the top of the house, under the roof and often used for storing things.

6. This is the room where people sit and relax. _____
7. The room in which you can wash yourself. _____
8. An outdoor platform outside the house where people can sit. _____
9. The cold place underneath the house where wine is kept. _____
10. The place around the house, often covered by a lawn, where small children can play.

Task 3 Describe your own room.

- Draw a plan of your room and describe it to your partner. Use the adjectives in the box below.
- Describe the furniture it has, where it is located in your room and what you use it for.
- What would you like to change about your room?

*cosy – large – tiny – huge – spacious – light – dark
draughty – noisy – quiet – decorated – modern*

A SINGLE FAMILY HOUSE IN A SUBURB



A suburban lifestyle offers a family-friendly atmosphere and a peaceful neighbourhood. This environment offers peace and luxury but requires a car to get to work. Suburbs normally have good schools and services but less work opportunities.

B A HOUSE/FLAT IN THE CITY CENTRE

Urban areas offer greater social, educational and career opportunities. They typically have a higher crime rate and less favourable schools than the suburbs. This area is close to nightlife and city attractions. People usually do not need a car. You can walk or take a bus, taxi or the underground to restaurants, bars, shops, museums, libraries and parks. You can also use public transportation or walk to work each day. There is little or no public parking.



C RENTED FLAT



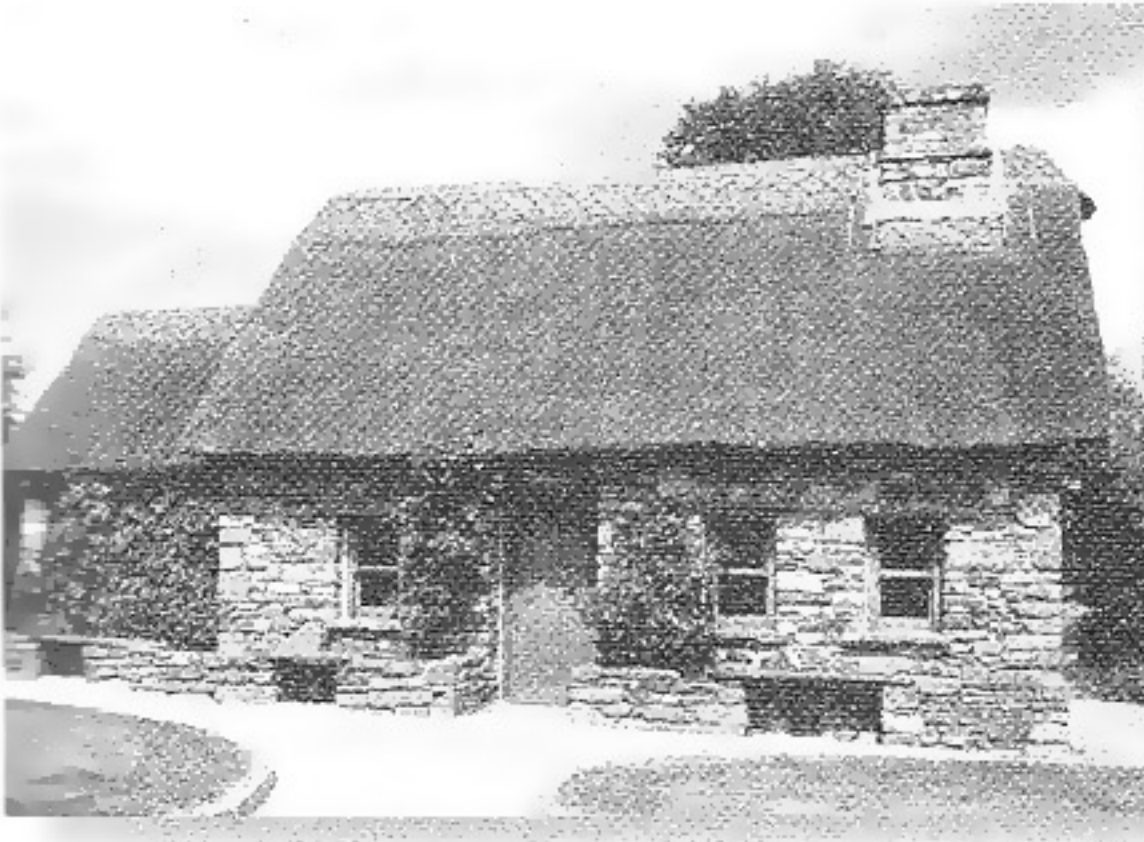
A flat to rent may be right for people who are looking for attractive prices and a low-maintenance lifestyle in the city. Lofts typically do not have interior walls and have more open space and higher ceilings than other homes. They require minimal maintenance. People who work in the city centre and need cheaper housing rent them. They are often used by middle income families, students or senior citizens. They are usually preferred by people who do not want to spend too much time around the house but want to enjoy their leisure time.

D SINGLE FAMILY HOUSE IN A VILLAGE

A rural environment offers privacy, space and the opportunity to do hobbies such as gardening. People normally live in a community where they know each other well. They often spend time together in clubs or pubs. People who prefer to be out of town but still with people prefer to live in such places. It attracts people who like to take care of their home and garden.



E COUNTRY COTTAGE



Adapted from www.frontdoor.com)

People who are fed up with living in towns among people choose to live in a country cottage. Normally, people have it as a weekend or holiday home. It offers opportunities to relax or to do hobbies such as hiking or fishing. People do not meet very often here, because cottages of this type are quite isolated. Sometimes, they invite friends for a barbecue or for the weekend. Some people have vineyards next to their cottages and grow grapes and produce wine there.

F MOBILE HOME (CARAVAN)



Adapted from www.coromal.com.au)

Caravanning can be exciting, adventurous, relaxing and may even involve working during your travels. It gives you the ability to do whatever you choose and go wherever you want. It is the friendships you make on your journeys that make the caravanning lifestyle so attractive. You can make long trips or just spend weekends in your caravan. Caravanning is something people of all ages can enjoy, it is not just for those who have retired. It creates a great family atmosphere.